

to this date one of the well known drives to buy. At just Rs 3,200, it still makes excellent value for money. 500 GB is still a lot of space and that too being available at such low prices make it one of the best drives around.

External storage

REIGNING CHAMPION

FreeCom Network Drive 500 GB
WD Passport Studio 320 GB

The *Best Buy* award for external storage drives is a tie between the WD Passport Studio 320 GB and the FreeCom Network Drive 500 GB.



The WD Passport Studio was the better looking drive. The Freecom was a plain box and the more function-oriented of the two. The WD Passport Studio 320 GB makes excellent sense for those who want portability. The Freecom Network Drive on the other hand is for those who want capacity at a sensible rate. It's not as compact as the Passport Studio 320 but it has something that the WD Passport Studio 320 GB doesn't — network support. This allows the somewhat portable Freecom drive to be used as a network storage device

as well. The performance on the network is also pretty amazing. The WD Passport Studio 320 GB comes with a Firewire port which allows even faster transfer rates.

Flash storage

REIGNING CHAMPION

Transcend JetFlash V60 4 GB

The 4 GB Transcend JetFlash V60 was one of the cheaper drives during the comparison test in the January issue of *Digit*, yet it managed to score a lot better than other drives in its price bracket.



CHALLENGER

Corsair Voyager 8 GB

The new Corsair Voyager 8 GB we tested churned far better numbers than the JetFlash V60 4 GB. The price for this flash drive is also cheaper than what the V60 4 GB was back then.

AND THE WINNER IS

Corsair Voyager 8 GB

A drive priced as little as Rs 875 performs more than two times better in some benchmarks. The price drops have made Flash drives so affordable that even performance oriented drives are now available at throw away prices. The Corsair Voyager 8 GB is the perfect example of this which is why it gets the award for *Best Buy* in the flash drive category.



BEST PERFORMER

SanDisk Ducati Edition (4 GB)

SanDisk's Ducati branded flash drive was designed and even shaped to be fast. It turned out to be the best performer of all the flash drives that we tested in January. Back then, it was priced at close to five times the price of a standard 4 GB flash drive. It was faster by a couple of times as well which made us award it the winner of the best overall performer in its category.

CHALLENGER

Corsair Voyager GT 16 GB

The new Corsair Voyager 2 GB visited the Test Centre early this year and now with price drops in the flash market; a 16 GB version of the same drive has arrived in time. It's called the Corsair Voyager GT 16 GB. Priced at around Rs 2,200, it's a little more than what 4 GB value flash drives were priced at.

AND THE WINNER IS

Corsair Voyager GT 16 GB

The Corsair Voyager GT 16 GB might not have the same fancy looks as the SanDisk Ducati Edition but it effortlessly beats its record. The performance from all the tests shows that the Corsair drive was faster than the SanDisk Ducati Edition. To make matters worse, the SanDisk Ducati 4 GB is still costlier than the faster Corsair Voyager GT 16 GB. The Voyager GT 16 GB is for all these reasons our choice for Best Overall Performer drive for its category.

